

1994 Sanguinetti reelected.

1995 Uruguay joins Mercosur common market with Brazil, Paraguay, and Argentina.

1999 Presidential election won by Colorado candidate Jorge Batlle.

2000 Foot-and-mouth disease forces temporary suspension of beef exports.

2004 Presidential election won by Tabaré Vázquez, heading a four-party coalition including the Socialist Party of Uruguay, who thus becomes the first left-wing president. Poverty-tackling measures such as a minimum wage are introduced.

2006 Uruguay pays off debt to the IMF.

2009 Discovery of large natural gas fields off Uruguay's Atlantic coast is announced.

2010 Former left-wing rebel José Mujica is elected president.

«280–81 The Slave Trade

Argentina



Once one of the richest countries in the world, Argentina is in crisis since defaulting on its debt.

1516 Juan de Solís is killed by the indigenous inhabitants after landing in what is now Argentina.

1526 Sebastian Cabot builds a fort on the estuary of the Río de la Plata.

1536 Pedro de Mendoza establishes the port of Santa María del Buen Aire on the site of the modern-day capital.

1590s Amerindians prevent the Spaniards from settling in the east of Argentina, but are finally subdued.

1776 Buenos Aires is separated from the Viceroyalty of Peru and becomes the seat of the Viceroyalty of Río de la Plata.

1816 Independence is achieved as the United Provinces of the River Plate. Conflict ensues between Unitarians advocating a centralized state ruled from Buenos Aires and the provincial Federalists of the interior.

1827 Bernardino Rivadavia, the republic's first president, resigns after his progressive Unitarian constitution is rejected by the provinces.

1829 Juan Manuel de Rosas, a Federalist caudillo with a broad base of support, is appointed governor of Buenos Aires province. His dictatorship extends the power of Buenos Aires.

1835–52 Rosas dictatorship does much to unify the country. His rule is authoritarian, even requiring the wearing of red to show support for the regime.

1853 Federal system set up.

1857 Europeans start settling the pampas: six million arrive by 1930, turning the region into one of the world's granaries and providing the mainstay of Argentina's export trade.

1862–80 Under three reforming governments, schools are built, public works started, and liberal reforms introduced.

1869 At the end of the War of the Triple Alliance against Paraguay, Argentina gains some land in the north from Paraguay.

1877 First refrigerated ship starts frozen beef trade to Europe.

1878–83 War against the pampas Amerindians leads to their almost total extermination.

1881 Argentina extends its rule southward through Patagonia to Tierra del Fuego.

1902 Boundary dispute with Chile over Tierra del Fuego is largely settled.

1916 Radical Hipólito Yrigoyen wins first democratic presidential elections and introduces much social legislation. He loses power in elections in 1922.

1928 Yrigoyen returns to power, but is ousted in a military coup in 1930; by now Conservatives in the country have adopted fascist leanings.

1938 The Radicals return to power, but serious illness causes their president, Roberto Ortiz, to retire; he is succeeded by the Conservative Ramón Castillo.

1943 Castillo is overthrown in a military coup; Juan Perón reorganizes trade unions as labor minister.

1946 Perón is elected president, with military and labor backing.

1949 A new constitution strengthens the presidency, allowing Perón to run for office again. He founds the Peronista political party.

1952 Eva Perón, "Evita," the charismatic wife of Juan Perón, dies of leukemia at the age of 33.

1955 Military coup ousts Perón after economy falters. Inflation, strikes, and unemployment destabilize the country. The military hands over power in 1958 to an elected president.

1963 After further military intervention and the banning of Peronista and Communist parties from standing in the election, Arturo Illía, a moderate liberal, takes power. He releases political prisoners and introduces some stability. Illía is overthrown in a military coup in 1966.

1972 Perón returns from exile in Madrid and in 1973 is reelected president with his third wife, Isabel, as vice president.

ARGENTINIAN PRESIDENT (1895–1974)

JUAN PERON

Juan Perón first came to prominence as part of a group of proto-fascist army colonels who overthrew the government in 1943. As secretary of labor and later vice president, he backed welfare legislation, winning the approval of the trade unions, who became the backbone of his later support.

In 1946 Perón was elected president. He pursued a path between capitalism and communism and was strongly nationalistic, anti-US, and anticommunist.

In power Perón became increasingly authoritarian, jailing opponents and censoring the press. While his wife Evita launched a public charm offensive, he purged the trade unions of communists and reorganized them along fascist lines. His rule aroused strong opposition: the Catholic church excommunicated him and he was overthrown in a coup in 1955.

Perón's second term as president from 1973–74 was not a success, but Peronism continues to be major political force.



1974 Juan Perón dies and is succeeded by his widow, Isabel, who is unable to exercise control over the country.

1976 Military junta seizes power: political parties are banned and brutal repression sees between 15,000 and 30,000 opponents of the regime disappear.

1981 General Leopoldo Galtieri becomes president, heading a three-man junta.

1982 Galtieri orders the invasion of the British-held Falkland Islands (Malvinas) and South Georgia. The UK retakes them in a war costing around 1,000 lives.

1983 Pro-human rights candidate Raúl Alfonsín wins presidency. Hyperinflation.

1989–92 Carlos Menem, a Peronist, is president; inflation down to 18 percent.

1995 Economy enters recession.

1999 Fernando de la Rúa is elected president leading a center-left alliance.

2000 Vice President Carlos "Chaco" Alvarez resigns over Senate bribes-for-votes scandal. Slump in beef exports after outbreak of foot-and-mouth disease. IMF grants Argentina aid of nearly \$40 billion.

2001 Strikes in protest against proposed austerity measures. The government defaults on debt repayments. Restrictions on bank withdrawals provoke a general strike. De la Rúa resigns.

2002 Peronist Eduardo Duhalde takes over the presidency—the fifth president in 12 days. Savings are wiped out as the peso is devalued, ending parity with the US dollar. Unemployed protesters, known as *piqueteros*, take to the streets.

2003 Néstor Kirchner becomes president. He restructures Argentina's debts and stabilizes economy.

2005 Workers from Zanon factory in Neuquén present a petition in Buenos Aires asking to keep control of their factory. Since 2001, over 200 factories have been reopened by their workers.

2007 Christina Fernandez de Kirchner, wife of former president Néstor Kirchner, is elected president.

2010 Argentina is first Latin American country to legalize same-sex marriages. Former president Kirchner dies.

«422–23 Viva la Revolución

«438–39 Dictatorship and Democracy